



(From left) Session chairperson Prabhu Chawla, Modi, Digvijay and Abdullah

BANGDEEP SINGH

LEADERSHIP TO END VOTEBANK POLITICS

The nation is waiting for a unifying political vision

"I speak the language of development"

NARENDRA MODI CHIEF MINISTER, GUJARAT

Since we have to make the dream of India in the 21st century come true, we also have to see what type of leadership and politics is needed to achieve it. If we take a close look at the political scene, we will realise that the country's politicians, despite their tall claims, are unable to respond to the aspirations of the youth. They will be answerable to them sooner or later. This is also the era of globalisation and we can't ensure a bright future while remaining isolated.

Why do politicians take to the path of votebank politics? I think they resort to short cuts when they fail to perform

and satisfy the aspirations of the common man. They have a tendency to appease certain segments to get votes and form the government.

Once upon a time, votebank politics was practised on the basis of emotional issues such as caste, community or region. In Tamil Nadu, there was no regionalism or separatism as long as Kamaraj was there, but when the Congress lost its grip in the state and other parties gained a foothold, Delhi exercised Article 356 repeatedly in the state. This tendency led to the rise of separatist feelings. Akalis were elected to power in Punjab, but they were also never allowed to rule for five years. All this led to regionalism.

That's how caste equations gained importance in the politics of the country. Someone propagated the MY (Muslim-Yadav) theory in the country, someone else AJGAR (Ahir-Jat-Gujjar-Rajput) and yet another KHAM (Kshatriya-Harijan-Muslim) politics. When all these theories lost their shine, votebank politics reached a new low.